

5.2.3 Developmental Psychology

Developmental psychology is concerned with the ways in which people change over their life span. This sub-section examines two aspects of development from early in a person's life; attachment and cognitive development.



Attachment

Candidates should:

- be aware of the development of early human attachment e.g. fearful reactions, secure and insecure attachments;
- be able to describe and evaluate Bowlby's theory of attachment;
- consider the possible long term effects of deprivation and privation;
- demonstrate knowledge of some cultural variations in childcare practices.

Cognitive Development

Candidates should:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of Piaget's stage theory of cognitive development;
- be able to describe some of Piaget's research and findings e.g. object permanence, e.g. egocentrism, conservation;
- be able to evaluate Piaget's research methodology;
- be able to evaluate Piaget's theory in the light of critical research studies e.g. McGarrigle and Donaldson.